

At the water hole

Meet my companion

Large animals often appear at a water hole with accompanying oxpeckers. These birds help the animal keep insects at bay, picking off ticks and leeches.

Impala

As well as insect control, oxpeckers clean up any wounds the host animal may have.

Red-billed oxpecker

During the dry season in the savanna, the only reliable place to find water is at a water hole. It can be a busy place.



That's better!

When a warthog takes a bath, it ends up dirtier than ever. The mud helps it to cool down and may help get rid of fleas and other nasty insects that infect the animal's skin.

Guinea fowl

Why are water holes such busy places?